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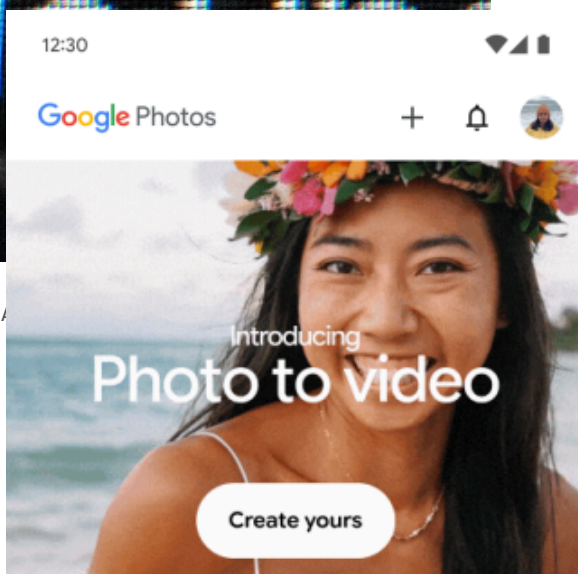
APPS



Google Photos adds AI features for 'remixing' photos in different styles, turning pics into videos

Google Photos is getting major AI chops. On Wednesday, Google [announced](#) a handful of new features that will allow users to [get more creative](#) with their photo memories, including an option to turn photos into videos, and “remix” photos into different styles, like anime, comics, sketches, or 3D animations.

The app will also centralize access to its creative tools — including both AI-powered and traditional tools — in a new “Create” tab in the Photos app. The two newly launched features will be housed in this tab, alongside other tools that let you create [collages](#), [highlight videos](#), and other [things](#).



Your tools

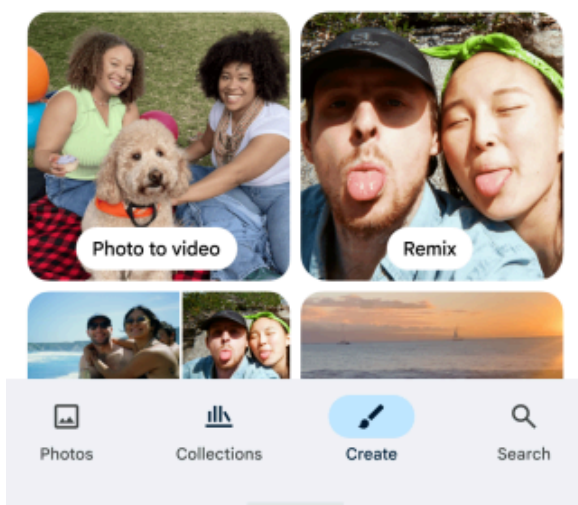


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The update brings AI prowess to one of Google’s most popular consumer-facing services: Google Photos today has [over 1.5 billion users](#). That will put AI into more people’s hands, including those who have not spent as much time experimenting with what AI can do. It also gives Google a large base to learn from as people try out the new features.

The company noted these features are experimental, so it will ask users to leave a thumbs-up or thumbs-down on the AI-generated images and videos to provide feedback. That feedback will help Google to improve the product and overall experience, it says.



IMAGE CREDITS:GOOGLE

With the new photo-to-video feature, similar to the [offering](#) already available in Gemini (and, [as of today, YouTube](#)), users will be able to make short videos from their own photos using Google’s Veo 2 model. In past years, animating old family photos was a clever trick, driving [downloads of apps like MyHeritage](#) as people brought [long-past relatives to life](#). Now that ability is being commoditized with the use of AI.

Once you’ve selected a photo, you can choose from one of two prompts — “Subtle movements,” or “I’m feeling lucky” — to turn the photo into a six-second video clip.

Photo to Video is rolling out today to users in the U.S. on Android and iOS.

Meanwhile, the new Remix feature, powered by [Google’s Imagen](#) AI model, lets you pick any photo from your gallery, then transform it into a different style in just seconds.

This feature will be available in the U.S. on Android and iOS in the next few weeks.

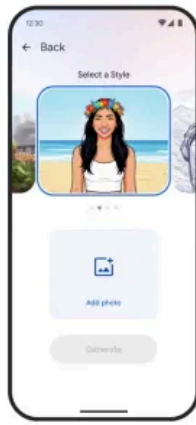


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Both features will include an invisible [SynthID](#) digital watermark on their outputs to identify them as being AI-generated. Google Photos already does this with other AI tools, like [images edited using Reimagine](#), for example. Generated videos will also include a visual watermark, similar to those generated by Gemini.

The Create tab will arrive in the U.S. in August. Google says it will update the tab over time, adding new tools and experiments and refining existing options.

The AI features were introduced alongside similar tools for YouTube Shorts, which is also now offering its own photo-to-video option as well as new AI effects, powered by Veo 2. (Shorts will get access to Veo 3 later this summer, Google said.)

Topics: [AI](#) [Apps](#) [Google Photos](#) [Imagen](#) [photos](#) [veo 2](#)

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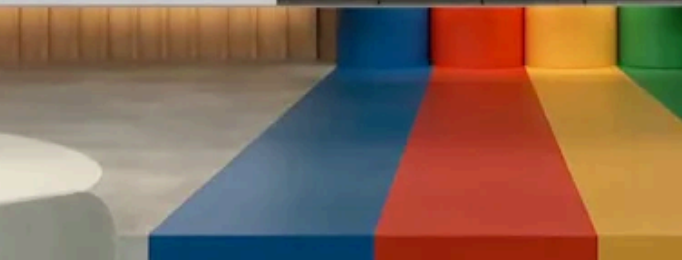


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APPS



Google brings AI-powered editing tools, like Magic Editor, to all Google Photos users for free

Sarah Perez — 9:00 AM PDT · April 10, 2024

Google Photos is getting an AI upgrade. On Wednesday, the tech giant announced that a handful of enhanced editing features previously [limited to Pixel devices](#) and [paid subscribers](#) — including its AI-powered Magic Editor — will now make their way to all Google Photos users for free. This expansion also includes Google's Magic Eraser, which removes unwanted items from photos; Photo Unblur, which uses machine learning to sharpen blurry photos; Portrait Light, which lets you change the light source on photos after the fact, and others.

The editing tools have historically been a selling point for Google's high-end devices, the Pixel phones, as well as a draw for [Google's cloud storage subscription product, Google One](#). But with the growing number of AI-powered editing tools flooding the market, Google has decided to make its set of AI photo editing features available to more people for free.

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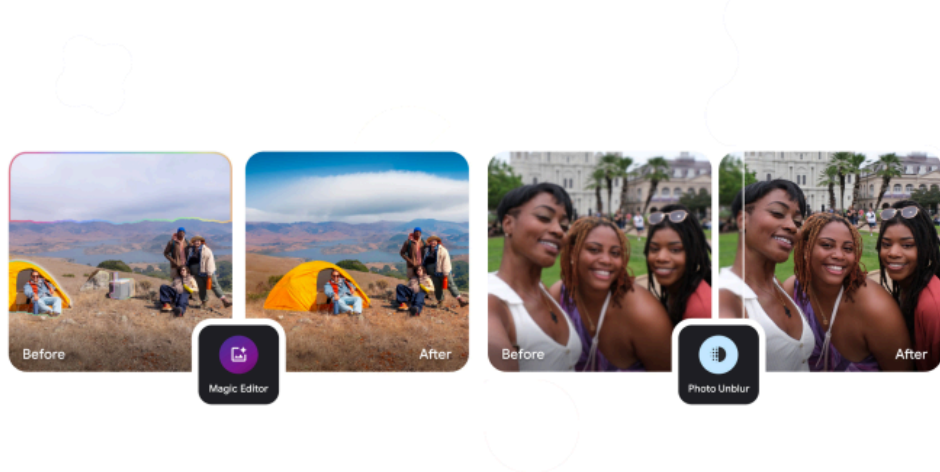


IMAGE CREDITS: GOOGLE

There are some caveats to this expansion, however.

For starters, the tools will only start rolling out on May 15 and it will take weeks for them to make it to all Google Photos users.

In addition, there are some hardware device requirements to be able to use them. On ChromeOS, for instance, the device must be a Chromebook Plus with ChromeOS version 118+ or have at least 3GB RAM. On mobile, the device must run Android 8.0 or higher or iOS 15 or higher.

The company notes that Pixel tablets will now be supported, as well.

Magic Editor is the most notable feature of the group. [Introduced last year](#) with the launch of the Pixel 8 and Pixel 8 Pro, this editing tool uses generative AI to do more complicated photo edits — like filling in gaps in a photo, repositioning the subject and other edits to the foreground or background of a photo. With Magic Editor, you can change a gray sky to blue, remove people from the background of a photo, recenter the photo subject while filling in gaps, remove other clutter and more.

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IMAGE CREDITS: GOOGLE

With the expansion, Magic Editor will come to all Pixel devices, while iOS and Android users (whose phones meet the

requirements) will get 10 Magic Editor saves per month. To go beyond that, they'll still need to buy a Premium Google One plan — meaning 2TB of storage and above.

The other tools will be available to all Google Photos users, no Google One subscription is required. The full set of features that will become available includes Magic Eraser, Photo Unblur, Sky suggestions, Color pop, HDR effect for photos and videos, Portrait Blur, Portrait Light (plus the add light/balance light features in the tool), Cinematic Photos, Styles in the Collage Editor and Video Effects.

Other features like the AI-powered Best Take — which merges similar photos to create a single best shot where everyone is smiling — will continue to be available only to Pixel 8 and 8 Pro.

Topics: [AI](#) [AI](#) [Apps](#) [Apps](#) [Artificial Intelligence \(AI\)](#) [Google](#)

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Facebook now allows users in the US & Canada to export photos and videos to Google Photos

Sarah Perez — 7:56 AM PDT · April 30, 2020

Facebook is today rolling out a tool that will allow users in the U.S. and Canada to export their Facebook photos and videos to Google Photos. This data portability tool was **first introduced** in Ireland in December, and has since been made available to other international markets.

To use the feature, Facebook users will need to click on “Settings,” followed by “Your Facebook Information,” then “Transfer a Copy of Your Photos and Videos.” Facebook will ask you to verify your password to confirm your identity in order to proceed. On the next screen, you’ll be able to choose “Google Photos” as the destination from the “Choose Destination” drop-down box that appears. You’ll also need your Google account information to authenticate with its service before the transfer begins.

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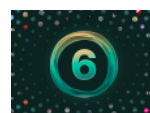
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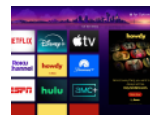
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The tool's release comes about by way of Facebook's [participation](#) in the [Data Transfer Project](#), a collaborative effort with other tech giants, including Apple, Google, Microsoft and Twitter, which focuses on building out common ways for people to transfer their data between online services.

Of course, it also serves as a way for the major tech companies to fend off potential regulation, as they'll be able to point to tools like this as a way to prove they're not holding their users hostage — if people are unhappy, they can just take their data and leave!

Facebook's Director of Privacy and Public Policy Steve Satterfield, [in an interview with Reuters](#) on Thursday, essentially confirmed the tool is less about Facebook being in service to its users, and more about catering to policymakers' and regulators' demands.

“...It really is an important part of the response to the kinds of concerns that drive antitrust regulation or competition regulation,” Satterfield told the news outlet.

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The launch also arrives conveniently ahead of a Federal Trade Commission hearing on September 22 that will be focused on data portability. Facebook said it would participate in that hearing, if approached, the report noted.

In Facebook’s [original announcement](#) about the tool’s launch last year, it said it would expand the service to include more than just Google Photos in the “near future.”

The transfer tool is not the only way to get your data out of Facebook. The company has offered [Download Your Information](#) since 2010. But once you have your data, there isn’t much else you can do with it — Facebook hasn’t had any

large-scale rivals since older social networks like Myspace, FriendFeed (RIP!) and Friendster died and Google+ failed.

In addition to the U.S. and Canada, the photo transfer tool has been launched in several other markets, including Europe and Latin America.

Topics: [data](#) [data portability](#) [Facebook](#) [Google](#) [Google Photos](#)

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